



TASHQI ISHLAR VAZIRLIGI

MAXFIY KO'RSATMALAR

PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS

**Ministry of Foreign Affairs
REPUBLIC OF UZBEKISTAN**



O'zbekiston Respublikasi
Tashqi ishlar vazirligi

Ministry of Foreign Affairs
of the Republic of Uzbekistan

Privileged Instructions

Fundamental Principles

- Uzbekistan's current boundaries are deemed critical to the national security interests of our nation and are non-negotiable. Altering our borders is a **Red Line** for the delegation. However, the delegation is allowed to seek insight from other nations regarding their views of our borders, and all information collected in this regard through diplomatic negotiations will prove useful to national security decision-making.
- Access to fresh water is vital for the people, agricultural sector, and national security. Water sharing agreements that acquire water from sources beyond Uzbekistan's borders are acceptable, and the delegation may seek agreements with neighboring nations in this regard. We will not agree to any arrangement that exports our water resources abroad. This is a **Red Line**. Acquiring information on what our neighboring nations might wish to do with their water resources on a large scale would be useful for national security decision-making.

Principle Negotiation Positions

These positions are to be presented openly and publicly to all attendees. However, the delegation should pursue the specific items outlined below, either bilaterally or multilaterally, and should ensure our red lines are not crossed in any diplomatic agreements that might be presented, discussed, or aggressively pursued.

- We are open to formal dialogue regarding natural resources across Central Asia and is interested in working collaboratively with our neighboring nations to find optimal ways to use those resources to better the lives of all people in the region.
- We supports economic integration and is open to proposals from neighboring nations regarding lowering trade barriers, increasing export of Uzbek-made products (agricultural products, minerals, oil, and natural gas), and increasing imports from all nations in the region interested in free trade.

These positions are to be held by the Uzbek delegation and should not be openly communicated except as outlined below.

- Our security is imperative. Hence, negotiation of security arrangements that support Uzbekistan's inherent right to self-defense and maintenance of territorial integrity will be entertained. The delegation does not have authority to enter into binding agreements in this regard, but exploring possible security arrangements that might be part of such agreements acquired during the negotiations is strongly encouraged.
- You will not enter any intelligence sharing agreements with any nation attending the summit. However, if the People's Republic of China is willing to share intelligence on Tajikistan or Kyrgyzstan, further dialogue on these points would be of interest. No

discussions of these possibilities will take place except in bilateral discussions. No other nations may know about this initiative.

Delegation Instructions

Ensure periodic reports, requests for further guidance, or clarifications to the instructions herein are submitted to the office of the Foreign Minister.

General: The delegation will work closely with and support the UN Special Representative of the Secretary-General's efforts to mediate this crisis. The delegation is directed to collect all available information about the negotiating positions of the other countries at the summit. Where possible, ascertain the other nation's flexible areas and try to bend the countries toward agreeing to Uzbek interests. The end goal of this summit for Uzbekistan is to reduce tensions and to return to the status quo regarding border demarcations and protection of Uzbekistan's water resources.

KAZAKHSTAN

Uzbekistan and Kazakhstan have a shared economic interest in the oil and gas sector. There is also a shared interest in mining, especially for rare earths and metals critical to the modern global economy. Where possible, advocate with the Kazakh delegation for shared agreements in these sectors. Exports of Uzbek oil and natural gas through Kazakh pipelines to the PRC would be a boon for Uzbekistan's economy. The delegation is empowered to directly negotiate such an arrangement, but the final agreement must be signed between the foreign ministers before it can be officially approved. Mining is also an area where we both would benefit from mutually sharing technological expertise. However, no Uzbek water may be sent to Kazakhstan to be used for mining processing. Kazakh water may, on the other hand, be imported from Kazakhstan to support the Uzbek mining industry, as well as the agriculture sector. The delegation is directed to seek opportunities in these regards in bilateral talks with the Kazakh delegation. No final agreements may be completed, but the framework for such agreements may be outlined to the greatest extent possible.

KYRGYZSTAN

Kyrgyzstan has also proven to be a challenge to our border security. Where possible, the delegation is directed to play the Kyrgyz delegation against the Tajik delegation in determining the details of Kyrgyzstan's negotiating objectives. The delegation is also directed to seek bilateral, long-term trade negotiations between Uzbekistan and Kyrgyzstan, with those trade deal negotiations to take place later. The framework for what those trade negotiations will look like may be discussed by your delegation. Communicate all information acquired from the Kyrgyz delegation back to the Foreign Ministry in an expedited format once acquired. Kyrgyzstan is also interested in upgrading their military hardware. We are willing to sell our old and obsolete equipment to the Kyrgyz military under the same framework as we would to Tajikistan. Ascertain the Kyrgyz military's needs and communicate those needs and interests to the Foreign Minister immediately. The Fergana Valley is of utmost importance to Kyrgyzstan—just as it is to us. Negotiations for sharing of water resources in this region are authorized, but no final agreements may be made at this summit. Finally, security interests between Kyrgyzstan and Uzbekistan are shared in understanding the Russian Federation's long-term interests in the Collective Security Treaty Organization (CSTO), of which we are not a member. However, Russian

government instability could result in Russian forces being invested into the CSTO member states, to include Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, and Tajikistan. Kyrgyzstan has indicated a lessened interest in the CSTO since Armenia withdrew, and Uzbek interests would be supported should Kyrgyzstan also withdraw from that treaty.

TAJIKISTAN

Tajikistan has proven to be a challenge to our security along our shared borders. Negotiations regarding border security and confidence building measures are authorized, but no final agreements may be made except between the foreign ministers. Ascertain Tajikistan's red lines regarding finalizing borders between our two nations. The delegation is authorized to be as amenable as is needed to encourage the Tajik delegation to show their hand regarding this point of contention. It is also acceptable to play the Tajik delegation against the Kyrgyz delegation in helping to assess areas where Uzbek policy needs to be strengthened or where communications with both nations must be stronger to ensure our current borders are maintained in perpetuity. Import of Tajik natural resources are encouraged, and the delegation is directed to seek potential areas of agreement. The Foreign Minister may concur with any trade deals negotiated. It is imperative Tajik trade agreement offers are communicated swiftly to the Foreign Minister. Provide as much detail as possible regarding trade agreements. The Tajik military is in a state of disrepair. They are interested in acquiring new or used military equipment, and we are willing to sell them our old or obsolete equipment, including combat jets, helicopters, artillery, and armored vehicles. No such deal may be finalized, but the delegation may explore the possibilities of such an agreement. India and Tajikistan maintain a security affiliation, and the Indian Air Force has, in the past, shared operation of two Tajik airfields. We are interested in learning if there is any intent to return to those arrangements, and, if so, what the details might include. Finally, Tajik militant movements are becoming a serious security threat to the region and beyond. Our intelligence services and the defense ministry are interested in any intelligence Tajik security authorities may be willing to share on a bilateral basis but make no commitments to such agreements. Establishing the framework for such agreements would be a success at this summit and would serve as a confidence building measure that does not require any change to the status quo regarding Uzbekistan's borders or water resources.

RUSSIA

The Russian Federation is a rapidly declining power. Nevertheless, President Putin remains a challenge for our long-term security interests. The delegation is directed to create strong rapport with the Russian delegation. Offer encouragement for their positions, but do not openly agree with them once you learn what their objectives may be. Communicate your discoveries back to the Foreign Minister and await specific guidance. However, the delegation is authorized and directed to discuss how our oil and natural gas might be more efficiently exported through Russian pipelines. Agree to no final deals in this regard, but determining Russian interests, and what they might want in return will be helpful for long-term negotiations between Moscow and Tashkent. Much of our military equipment is of Soviet design and is aging. Russian military equipment has proven wholly ineffective on the modern battlefield. Encourage the Russian delegation to offer defense agreements, and collect all available information in this regard, but make no agreements of any kind. Communicate your findings regarding Russian arms packages back to the Foreign Ministry.

Where possible, ascertain Russia's intentions to seek more assistance for their war effort in Ukraine. Again, communicate that information back to Tashkent immediately.

PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA

The People's Republic of China has become of tantamount economic interest to Uzbekistan. Supplying the PRC with oil, gas, metals, and minerals would spur economic expansion and help to improve our opportunities. The delegation is directed to seek a framework for long-term trade agreements with the PRC delegation, but do not finalize any such agreements. Also, ensure the bilateral-only talks with China in this regard do not include any agreement to accept PRC export bank loans for Chinese infrastructure projects. Uzbek citizens will carry out all construction on all projects linked to the PRC's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI). The delegation is directed to seek information regarding the PRC's next phases in the BRI as it pertains to Tajikistan, Kyrgyzstan, Kazakhstan, and Uzbekistan. Our security services are also interested in acquiring information on Tajik and Kyrgyz threats to Uzbek interests. If the PRC delegation seems amenable to discussing sharing intelligence in this regard through a formal agreement, the framework for such an agreement may be explored, but make no final commitments. We are particularly interested in extremism, separatist movements, and any direct threats the Kyrgyz or Tajik military may pose to our national security interests. Finally, we are ready to upgrade our military equipment. The PRC's PLA has become a formidable combat force. The delegation is directed to explore possible arms deals between the PRC. Seek to understand what might be available and what the costs might be per unit (combat aircraft, transport aircraft, helicopters (both attack and utility), armor, armored vehicles, field artillery and rocket artillery, and communications equipment). Share whatever details the delegation acquires immediately with the Foreign Minister.

INDIA

We have no natural affiliation with India. Nevertheless, India's economy is expanding rapidly and may prove to be a profitable export market for Uzbek products. Where possible, seek economic discussions with India but make no commitments; details would be worked out in later bilateral talks between New Delhi and Tashkent. India has also become a viable arms exporter, and Uzbekistan is interested in improving defense capabilities. The delegation is authorized to open dialogue on defense acquisitions, but do not discuss this option unless in bilateral negotiations. Finally, the Foreign Ministry is keenly interested in India's technical advances, especially in IT, cyber security, and related technologies. Inquiries along these lines for potential trade negotiations or technical assistance are authorized. But again, finalize no deals as that must be accomplished through dedicated negotiations by the Foreign Ministry.

There may be times when the Foreign Minister is unable to respond immediately to your communication. Under those circumstances, the delegation should proceed as directed in this guidance.